

Figure 1: Features of pfSense

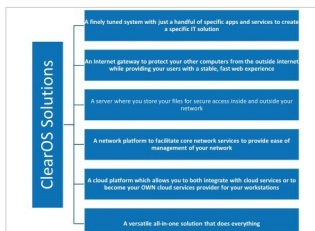


Figure 2: ClearOS solutions

IPFire

IPFire is another open source Linux based firewall, which can be used by the SOHO segment. IPFire has implemented the stateful packet inspections firewall, which stores information about each connection. This will help to provide security over the network. It is very easy to manage, and is modular and highly flexible.

The features of IPFire can best be seen in Figure 3.

As IPFire uses stateful packet inspection, it can associate every packet's transit to the connection. This information can be used to open the path for response packets automatically. The firewall figures out the rule for the opposite direction automatically.

Smoothwall

Smoothwall is an open source Linux firewall that is very flexible. It has a Web interface named Web Access Manager, which is highly configurable. And it has a clean design that is easy to understand and manage.

Some of the features of Smoothwall are illustrated in Figure 4.

Other than the above features, Smoothwall also provides solutions outlined below:

- Protects your network from Web-borne malware attacks

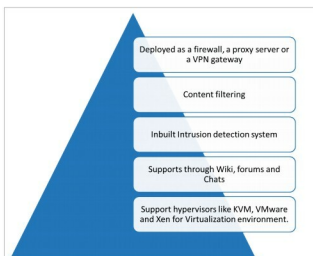


Figure 3: IPFire

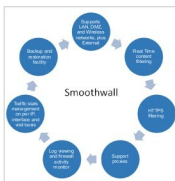


Figure 4: Smoothwall

- Uses social networks productively
- Easily builds filtering policies based on the user, category, time and location

Shorewall

Shorewall is a popular Linux open source firewall, which is built upon the NetFilter system on Linux machines. It uses the iptables tool to access configuration files. It is a robust firewall system, which can be used over large networks. It is nothing but the command line environment which interacts with text configuration files. We can set the interfaces, the policies that apply to interfaces and the exception in policies by using the configuration files. Shorewall configures NetFilter using these configuration files with the help of the iptables utility.

Shorewall can be used on a standalone Linux machine, on a dedicated firewall system or as a multi-function gateway.

The features of Shorewall are illustrated in Figure 5.

Endian Firewall

Endian Firewall is a full-featured unified threat management solution, which uses the stateful packet inspection concept based firewall. It can be deployed as a proxy, gateway, and router with Open VPN.